[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Tehran, March 22, 1852*

I do not know whether you have heard that I was married last autumn to a Georgian lady of good family and thank God she makes me a most kind agreeable and affectionate wife. She is pretty and about thirty three years old. She has no money in property but, as is often the case in Asiatic marriages she has brought with her a great deal of what is well worth having, such as her own rich dresses, carpets curtains, embroidered cushions, and other things which tend to make a house comfortable. She speaks Armenian and Turkish and writes the former so fast that to day she has written two letters for my one. I would make her write to your wife in that language but you would have little chance of getting the letter read in New York. One of her carpets just fits the centre of our large room which is about twenty four feet by fourteen, with the window, a recess eleven feet by six, this carpet however which is a very rich one, we only put down on high festivals; my old carpets do very well for common wear. Lately she has been busy turning out the wool of the sofa having it and the chintz well washed and restuffing it, so you see she tends to keep my house in order.

I am going on much as usual and altho' I have not gain[ed] much in money by the Gazette I have gained a great deal in consideration both amongst the Persians and Europeans. I do not see so much of the latter as formerly. I was always fond of home and now that I am married I am more so than formerly but I am still received most kindly at the Foreign Missions and thank God I am contented with my lot.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Neeawaran near Tehran, June 22, 1852*

You will see that my letter is dated from Neeawaran. This is a small town some ten miles north of Tehran, and from that city here there is a gentle ascent, the Elbourz mountains rising in precipitous peaks to the height of perpetual snow almost behind the town. The place itself is built in terraces so that going up some of the streets is almost like going up stairs. The King has a summer palace here and as I am obliged to consult the Prime Minister and also sometimes the King himself about articles to be put in the gazette, I am ordered to be here and carry on the work here, all except the actual printing which is done in town. The climate here is most cool and agreeable and I am much better off in this, as thank God in many other respects than I was last year for then I was ordered to carry on the newspaper in town and altho I lived at a village some seven miles out, going backwards and forwards in the great heats, four days in the week, and working hard all day in such a filthy climate as Tehran is during the greater part of three months, was by no means agreeable. My wife is living at

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